November 2026

Yi Wang, Ph.D. (she/her)

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RESEARCH & TEACHING INTERESTS

Housing Policy ● Population Health ● Climate Resilience ● Urban Data Science ● Spatial Analysis

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Research Associate

People, Health & Place Unit, Prevention Research Center,
Bursky School of Public Health, Washington University in St. Louis 2025 -

Brown School of Social Work, Washington University in St. Louis 2024 - 2025

Senior Research Associate

Evicted in Oregon Research Team, Center for Urban Studies, Portland State University 2023 - 2025

Research Assistant

Center for Urban and Regional Affairs, University of Minnesota 2018 – 2023

Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation, University of Minnesota 2022

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Public Affairs (Minor in Population Studies), University of Minnesota, Twin Cities 2023

Master of Urban Planning, Tsinghua University 2018

Exchange Student, TU Delft Faculty of Architecture & the Built Environment 2017

Bachelor of Engineering in Urban Planning, Tianjin University 2015

Exchange Student, NUS School of Design and Environment 2013

REFEREED JOURNAL ARTICLES

14. Leão, A. L. F., **Wang, Y.**, Banda, B., Balogun, M., Xing, E., Gudapati, S., Rios-Hernandez, M., Jacobs, N., & Reis, R. (2026). Exploring Spatial Inequities and Livability: A mixed-methods study using artificial intelligence and community insights. *Journal of Urban Health.*

13. **Wang, Y.**, Crenshaw, A. N., & Reis, R. (2026). Federal Cuts and Public Health: Social Media Sentiment Among Federal Employees. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*.

12. **Wang, Y.**, McMurtry, C., & Han, H.-S. (2026). Investigating the impact of Kansas City's tenant right to counsel program on eviction court outcomes. *Journal of Urban Affairs*.

11. Silva, M. F., Gierbolini-Rivera, R. D., **Wang, Y.**, Silva, A. A. P., Eyler, A., Salvo, D, & Reis, R. S. (2026). A Content Analysis of Physical Activity and Priority Climate Action Plans across U.S. States. *Journal of Physical Activity and Health*.

10. **Wang, Y.**, & Bates, L. K. (2026). Eviction Filing Patterns in Subsidized Housing: Differences by Owner, Manager, and Program Type. *Housing Policy Debate*.

9. **Wang, Y.**, Silva, A. A. P., Silva, M. F., Rios-Hernandez, M., Leão, A. L. F., Gierbolini-Rivera, R. D., Yang, S., Eyler, A., Brownson, R., & Reis, R. S. (2026). Do Priorities for Developing Livable Cities Change Over Time? *Journal of Planning Education and Research*.

8. Reis, R. S., Leão, A. L. F., **Wang, Y.**, Silva, M. F., & Salvo, D. (2025). Enhancing the Socioecological Model to Integrate Equity and Planetary Health: A Framework for Understanding Complex Interventions Shaping Population Health and Active Living. *Journal of Physical Activity and Health*.

7. Brown, A.†, Kye, S. H.†, & **Wang, Y.†** (2025). Short-Lived Relief: The Racial Geography of Rebounding Eviction Rates in Post-Moratorium St. Louis. *Socius*. † ***These authors contributed equally to this work.***

6. Crenshaw, A. N., **Wang, Y.**, Leão, A. L. F., Kepper. M., Gierbolini-Rivera, R. D., & Reis, R. (2025). Community Perspectives on Livability Metrics: Insights Using Designing for Dissemination and Sustainability. *Cities & Health*.

5. Goetz, E. G., **Wang, Y.**, & Damiano, A. (2025). Extra-judicial Evictions and Changing Landlord Strategies in Response to the Eviction Moratorium. *Housing Policy Debate*.

4. VanHeuvelen, J. S., **Wang, Y.**, & VanHeuvelen, T. (2024). Political Context and State-Level Health Behavior Disparities. *Socius*.

3. **Wang, Y.** (2023). Housing cost burden, homeownership, and self-rated health among migrant workers in Chinese cities: The confounding effect of residence duration. *Cities*.

2. **Wang, Y.**, & Goetz, E. G. (2022). No Place in the City: The Segregation of Affordable Formal Private Rentals in Beijing. *Housing Policy Debate*.

1. Goetz, E. G., & **Wang, Y.** (2020). Overriding Exclusion: Compliance with Subsidized Housing Incentives in the Massachusetts 40B Program. *Housing Policy Debate*.

JOURNAL ARTICLES IN-PROGRESS

7. **Wang, Y.**, Silva, A. A. P., Hockman, E., Leão, A. L. F., Silva, M. F., Neto, P. N., Florindo, A., & Reis, R. Geographically Uneven Resilience Gains: Climate Resilience of Minha Casa Minha Vida Affordable Housing Program Compared with Informal Settlements in Brazil. Under review, *Cities*.

6. **Wang, Y.†**, Pai, Y.-T.†, Silva, A. A. P., Silva, M. F., Freixas, C., Underhill, L., Reis, R. Cumulative Climate Vulnerability at Subsidized Housing Sites in the United States: The Case of Choice Neighborhoods Initiatives. Under review, *Journal of Housing and the Built Environment*. † ***These authors contributed equally to this work.***

5. **Wang, Y.,** Fowler, P. J., & Seymour, E. Built-to-Fail Home Financing: Evidence from Eviction Court Exhibits on Predatory Contract-for-Deed and Rent-to-Own Practices. Under review, *Housing Policy Debate*.

4. Enamorado, T.†, & **Wang, Y.†** When Housing Insecurity Reaches the Ballot Box: The Demobilizing Effects of Eviction. † ***These authors contributed equally to this work.***

3. Reis, R., **Wang, Y.**, Silva, M. F., Leão, A. L. F., Hino, A. A., & Rech, C. R. Climate-Resilient Active Living in Brazil: Municipal Spatial Evidence from the Health Academy Program. Under review, *The Journal of Climate Change and Health*.

2. Silva, M. F., **Wang, Y.**, Leão, A. L. F., Silva, A. A. P., Freixas, C., Underhill, L., & Reis, R. S. Identifying opportunities and barriers to enhance residents' health and climate resilience in affordable housing: insights from participatory group model building in Baltimore, USA. Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of Urban Health.*

1. Graff, M., Pradhan, B., & **Wang, Y.** Investigating Administrative Burden through Spatial Accessibility in Energy Assistance. Revise & Resubmit, *International Public Management Journal*.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL PUBLICATIONS

8. Blackmon, K., Yearby, R., Lewis, C. N., **Wang, Y.**, & Hutton, S. (2026). Unsafe Rental Housing and Poor Health: Using Tenant Organizing to Empower Community and Address Housing Deterioration. In *The Other Housing Crisis: Ending the Deterioration and Loss of Affordable Homes*. Princeton University Press.

7. Reis, R. S., Leão, A. L. F., Silva, M. F., Neto, P. N., Silva, A. A. P., **Wang, Y.**, & Florindo, A. (2026). Reframing affordable housing in Latin America through public health and climate resilience. *Cities*.

6. Leão, A. L. F., Rios-Hernandez, M., **Wang, Y.**, Silva, M. F., Goulardins, G., Silva, A., Florindo, A., Neto, P. N., & Reis, R. S. (2025). *Healthy, Equitable, and Climate-Resilient Cities Through Minha Casa Minha Vida: Guidance for Municipal Action*. Zenodo.

5. Leão, A. L. F., Goulardins, G. S., Silva, M. F., Silva, A. A. P., **Wang, Y.**, Rios-Hernandez, M., Paula, A. L., Neto, P. N., Florindo, A., & Reis, R. (2025). *GMB Workshop Report – Evaluating the Impacts of Affordable Housing on Physical Activity, Health, and Climate Resilience in Brazil*. Zenodo.

4. Farrington, A., Bates, L., Carroll, C., **Wang, Y**., Amir-Ghassemi, A., Cho, M., Cholula, N., & Lindstrom, A. (2025). Eviction Court in Multnomah County: Improved Legal Outcomes for Tenants Amidst Rising Eviction Filings. *Urban Studies and Planning Faculty Publications and Presentations*.

3. **Wang, Y**., Bates, L., Amir-Ghassemi, A., Cho, M., Zapata, M., Greene, J., Carroll, C., & MacArthur, D. (2024). Eviction in Oregon's Subsidized Affordable Housing. *Center for Urban Studies Publications and Reports, Portland State University.*

2. Goetz, E. G., **Wang, Y.**, & Damiano A. (2022). The Impact of the COVID-19 Eviction Moratorium on Landlord-Initiated Displacement Actions in Minnesota. *Center for Urban and Regional Affairs, University of Minnesota*.

1. Goetz, E. G., Williams, R. A., **Wang, Y.**, Martin A. A., Vergara, A. (2022). Seeking Closure: The Lowry Grove Report. *Center for Urban and Regional Affairs, University of Minnesota*.

DATA & TOOLS

2026 Lead developer. *Choice Neighborhoods Initiative Data Toolkit*. People, Health & Place Unit – St. Louis.

2026 Lead developer. *MCMV Climate Resilience Tracker*. People, Health & Place Unit – St. Louis.

2026 First author. *Geocoded Dataset of Brazil's Minha Casa, Minha Vida (MCMV) Faixa 1 Projects, 2009-2019*. Harvard Dataverse.

IN THE MEDIA

2026 *Kansas City Helping Renters Avoid Eviction*. FlatlandKC.

2026 *A St. Louis program aimed to prevent evictions. A short-term rental fee could help sustain it*. STLPR.

2026 *Trackers map climate resilience in affordable housing developments in Brazil, U.S.* Bursky School of Public Health.

2026 *Right-to-counsel program reduces likelihood of eviction*. Bursky School of Public Health.

2025 *Tenants Speak Out Amid Wave of Evictions at NAYA Affordable Housing*. Underscore Native News.

2024 *Oregon affordable housing landlords filed thousands of evictions in recent years, study finds*. The Oregonian / OregonLive.

2024 *Oregon saw over 5K recent affordable housing eviction filings, PSU finds*. KOIN 6 News.

2024 *Subsidized housing tenants face eviction at higher rates, PSU report finds*. Portland State University.

2022 *Study: Minnesota renters didn't report surge of 'informal evictions' during moratorium*. Minnesota Reformer.

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

2015 Honorary Mention, TEAM20 Architecture and Urban Planning Competition
2014 Honorary Mention, Tianjin International Design Week (TDW) Award
2014 Sustainable City Fellowship, Oak Foundation (Switzerland)
2013 Selected Award, Architects in Mission (AIM) International Design Competition

GRANTS - FUNDED

2026 Here & Next Global Incubator Seed Grant — $25,000
"Applying Artificial Intelligence to Assess Spatial Inequities in the Global South"
PIs: Rodrigo Reis & Ana Luiza Favarão Leão
Role: Co-Investigator

2025 Here & Next Ignite Interdisciplinary Grant — $49,964
"An Evidence-Based Toolkit to Conduct Research on Climate Resilience and Health Impacts in Affordable Housing"
PIs: Rodrigo Reis, Lindsay Underhill & Catalina Freixas
Role: Co-Investigator

2025 Here & Next Spark Funding: Convening Track — $20,000
"Designing a Community-centered Action Plan to Enhance Climate Resilience and Public Health Equity in Affordable Housing"
PIs: Lindsay Underhill & Catalina Freixas
Role: Co-Investigator

2025 Here & Next Global Incubator Seed Grant — $25,000
"Evaluating the Impacts of Affordable Housing on Physical Activity, Health, and Climate Resilience in Brazil"

PIs: Rodrigo Reis & Alex Antonio Florindo
Role: Co-Investigator

2024 Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity Small Grant — $1,000
"Predatory Landlord Practices: Housing Code Violations and Evictions in the City of St. Louis"
Role: PI

2024 Here & Next Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding — $50,000
"Measuring Spatial Inequities in Urban Communities"
PIs: Rodrigo Reis & Nathan Jacobs
Role: Research Staff

2022-2025 Oregon Housing and Community Services Department Funding — $1,999,556
"Evictions Prevention and Diversion"
PI: Lisa K. Bates
Role: Research Staff

GRANTS - PENDING

2026 Russell Sage Foundation (RSF) Core Research Grant — $75,000
"Evictions in Subsidized Housing: Institutional Discretion and Decision-Making Among Housing Providers"
Role: PI
Status: Full proposal invited (**about 15% of letters of inquiry advance to this stage, per RSF*)

TEACHING & MENTORING

2026 **Postdoc Mentor**. Master of Public Health Practicum: Neighborhood Vacancy and Mental Health. *Washington University in St. Louis.* (Mentee: Dureti Garoma)

2026 **Postdoc Mentor**. Center for the Environment Summer Undergraduate Research Program. *Washington University in St. Louis.* (Mentee: Eliana Oden)

2025 **Guest Lecturer**. People, Health & Place: International Perspectives on Urban Health, Physical Activity, and Design in Brazil and the United States. *Washington University in St. Louis.*

2025 **Postdoc Mentor**. Center for the Environment Summer Undergraduate Research Program. *Washington University in St. Louis.* (Mentee: Ellie Hockman)

2022 **Instructor**. Working with Data: Finding, Managing, and Using Data. *University of Minnesota.*

2021 **Instructor**. Working with Data: Finding, Managing, and Using Data. *University of Minnesota.*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026 - 2028 **Secretary**. Planners of Color Interest Group (POCIG) E-Board.

2026 **Discussant**. "Climate and Land Use: Plans, Policies, and Networks."Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference.

2026 **Organizer**, **Moderator**. "Evictions in Subsidized Housing." International Conference on Urban Affairs (ICUA).

2025 **Organizer**. "Housing Stability and Financial Well-Being." Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Research Conference.

2024 - **Postdoc Representative**. Data and Methods Core, Prevention Research Center, Washington University in St. Louis.

2022 - 2023 **Student Representative**. MURP Faculty Search Committee, Humphrey School, University of Minnesota.

2021 - 2022 **Student Representative**. Ph.D. Committee, Humphrey School, University of Minnesota.

Reviewer:

Cities, Journal of Planning Education and Research, Urban Planning, Housing Policy Debate, Journal of Housing and the Built Environment, Local Environment, Population Research and Policy Review, Socius, Social Sciences, American Journal of Public Health, Health & Social Care in the Community, PLOS ONE.

Member:

Alumni Population Studies Trainee, Minnesota Population Center (MPC)
Member, Urban Affairs Association (UAA)
Member, Population Association of America (PAA)
Member, Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP)
Member, Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)

INVITED TALKS

2026 "AI-Augmented Urban Livability Research." AI and Environmental Research Symposium. Washington University in St. Louis.

2025 "Methodological Approaches in Affordable Housing for Population Health: The Case of the MCMV Program." Affordable Housing Webinar Series. Washington University in St. Louis.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA. "Built-to-Fail Home Financing: Evidence from Eviction Court Exhibits on Predatory Contract-for-Deed and Rent-to-Own Practices."

2026 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Pittsburgh, PA. "Geographically Uneven Resilience Gains: Climate Resilience of Minha Casa Minha Vida Affordable Housing Program Compared with Informal Settlements in Brazil. "

2026 Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO. "Eviction and Voter Turnout: An Individual-Level Analysis (Poster)."

2026 International Conference on Urban Affairs (ICUA), Chicago, IL. "Eviction Filing Patterns in Subsidized Housing: Differences by Owner, Manager, and Program Type."

2025 Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA. "Investigating the Impact of Kansas City's Tenant Right to Counsel Program on Eviction Outcomes." And "Examining Predatory Contract for Deed Practices through Eviction Court Data."

2025 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN. "Examining Predatory Contract-for-Deed Practices through Eviction Court Data."

2025 Law & Society Association (LSA) Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL. "Investigating the Impact of Kansas City's Tenant Right to Counsel Program on Eviction Outcomes."

2025 International Conference on Urban Affairs (ICUA), Vancouver, Canada. "Predatory Landlord Practices: Housing Code Violations and Evictions in The City of St Louis."

2024 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Seattle, WA. "The Role of Community Action Agencies in Disaster Response: The Case of Covid-19 Emergency Rental Assistance."

2024 Urban Affairs Association (UAA) Annual Conference, New York, NY. "Access and Equity in Disaster Response: The Case of Covid-19 Emergency Rental Assistance."

2023 Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Research Conference, Atlanta, GA. "Protected from Eviction? A Study of Subsidized Housing Evictions in Oregon."

2023 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Chicago, IL. "Protected from Eviction? A Study of Subsidized Housing Evictions in Oregon."

2023 Urban Affairs Association (UAA) Annual Conference, Nashville, TN. "Extra-Judicial Evictions: Changing Landlord Strategies During and After the Eviction Moratorium (Poster)."

2023 Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA. "Eviction Moratorium and Threats of Eviction in the Twin Cities."

2022 Urban Affairs Association (UAA) Annual Conference, Washington DC. "Development for whom? The Impact of Shantytown Redevelopment Projects (SRPs) on Rental Affordability in Beijing."

2022 Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA. "Microsimulation and the Risk of Eviction Among Family Members (Poster)."

2021 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference (Virtual). "Housing Affordability and Self-Rated Health of Migrant Workers in Chinese Cities."

2021 Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting (Virtual). "Housing Cost Burden and Physical Health of Internal Migrant Populations in Urban China (Poster)."

2020 International Association for China Planning (IACP) Annual Conference (Virtual). "No Place in the City: The Segregation of Affordable Market-Rate Rentals in Beijing."

2020 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference (Virtual). "No Place in the City: The Segregation of Affordable Market-Rate Rentals in Beijing."

2019 Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Greenville, SC. "Exclusion or Fair Share? Local Government Compliance with Affordable Housing Incentives."

2019 International Conference on China Urban Development, Beijing, China. "Exclusion or Fair Share? Local Government Compliance with Affordable Housing Incentives."

2019 Urban Affairs Association (UAA) Annual Conference, Los Angeles, CA. "Residential segregation of low-to-moderate-income households in Beijing: An empirical study of private sector rental housing."

2017 Spatial Planning and Sustainable Development (SPSD) Annual Conference, Seoul, South Korea. "Exploring the Residential Segregation in Beijing using Rental Housing Data."

SKILLS

Data Science: Python, R, Stata
Spatial Analysis: Python (GeoPandas, PySAL), ArcGIS, QGIS
Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Rodrigo Reis
Professor, Bursky School of Public Health
Washington University in St. Louis
reis.rodrigo@wustl.edu

Edward Goetz
Professor of Urban Planning, Humphrey School
Director, Center for Urban and Regional Affairs
University of Minnesota
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Patrick Fowler
Professor, Bursky School of Public Health
Director, Doctoral Program in Public Health Sciences
Washington University in St. Louis
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Ted Enamorado
Associate Professor of Political Science
Washington University in St. Louis
ted@wustl.edu

Eric Seymour
Associate Professor, Bloustein School of Planning and Public Policy
Rutgers University
eric.seymour@rutgers.edu

Hye-Sung Han
Associate Professor, School of Public Affairs & Administration
University of Kansas
hshan@ku.edu